Assignment: Capturing and Reading Network Traffic

During my captures, I observed that http was not generating much traffic at first, so I had to continuously refresh the website in my Firefox browser for the full 60 seconds to capture enough data. I also learned that if you do not stop the recording first, the "Export Specified Packets" button stays grayed out. I was most surprised by how much background TCP and DNS data my system sends automatically, even when I am just sitting on one web page. Because Wireshark captures all this raw data, a big security risk is that if a hacker is on the same network, they can easily see exactly what websites I am visiting and read any unencrypted HTTP traffic.